
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Phone habits



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Neil

Hello and welcome to Real Easy English. In this podcast, we have real conversations in easy English to help you learn. I'm Neil.

Becca

And I'm Becca. You can find a video version of this podcast along with a transcript to help you learn on our website, bbclearningenglish.com.

Neil

Hi Becca, how are you?

Becca

I'm well, thanks, Neil. How about you?

Neil

I'm pretty good. Today, we're talking about phones. Now, Becca, how much time do you spend on your phone every day?

Becca

Ooh, I don't know the number. I haven't checked my **screen time** in a while. So, your **screen time** is the time in which you spend looking on your phone screen. I probably would guess that I spend quite a few hours looking at my phone. How about you?

Neil

Yeah, I spend probably a lot of time on my phone every day, and I'm not really happy about that because I think it's a waste of time. But I do it, like millions of other people.

Becca

Mmm, yeah. I mean, phones can be very useful. You can get information very quickly.

Neil

Yes, this is true. So, they are also really handy of course for finding out information quickly, and you can do loads of things that used to be quite hard to do.

Becca

Yeah. One of those things that we can probably do better with phones is to connect with people and to have contact with people. Do you get lots of **notifications** from your friends and family on your phone?

Neil

Because I don't like spending too much time on my phone, I turned off my **notifications**. Now, **notifications** are the little messages that you get from apps when people or the app wants to tell you something.

Becca

OK. So, that's a good tip really, if you want to reduce your **screen time**, is to turn off your **notifications**.

Neil

Yeah. I also try not to **doomscroll**. What's **doomscrolling**?

Becca

That's probably how I spend a lot of time on my phone. So, when you **doomscroll**, you look at negative news stories or things that make you feel maybe a bit upset, a bit sad. And you just keep scrolling and scrolling and scrolling and it really doesn't make you feel good.

Neil

And so if you do, like you Becca, a lot of **doomscrolling**, that could be a sign of an **addiction**. Now, an **addiction** is something that you can't stop doing. So, for example, an obvious example is smoking. People who smoke – they have an **addiction**. It's something they have to do. And we hear a lot about phone **addiction**.

Becca

And it's really hard to stop an **addiction**. Even though I know **doomscrolling** is very bad for me and it doesn't make me feel good, I can't stop doing it.

Neil

I don't think you're alone, Becca, but do you think most people look at their phone too much?

Becca

I do, and I think that it doesn't matter how old you are. I see phone **addictions** with people my age, people younger and people older. I think that a lot of people are addicted to their phones.

Neil

Yeah. If you just look around anywhere. Most people have their head down at that angle, looking at their phone, missing what's going on in the real world.

Becca

OK. Let's recap the vocabulary we learnt in this episode. First **screen time**, and that's the time that you spend looking at an electronic screen. We usually use it to talk about looking at our phones.

Neil

We heard **doomscrolling**. **Doomscrolling** is when you look at one story after another, after another, after another, and they're usually bad news stories.

Becca

Notifications are the messages that apps will send you to make you check your phone.

Neil

If something is an **addiction**, it means that you can't stop doing it.

Becca

That's it for this week's episode of Real Easy English. You can head to our website for a free worksheet to test what you've learnt. That's at bbclearningenglish.com.

Neil

And we'll be back next week with another conversation in easy English. Goodbye for now.

Becca

Bye!